

TaskWA

User Manual

Everything your team needs in two pages — and everything the administrator needs in the rest.

Version 1.3 · July 2026

Part I

For team members (pages 2–3)

Part II

For the administrator (pages 4–7)

I For team members — the only pages you need

TaskWA sends you one WhatsApp message each morning with your open tasks. You reply in the same chat. That's the whole system.

Your morning message looks like this:

Good morning, Ravi - 3 open tasks today:

1. [HIGH] Send Q2 invoice to Alpha LLC - due Fri 17 Jul
2. Buy cement for Site B - due today
- [!] 3. Fix generator - BLOCKED 2d: waiting on quote

Reply: 1 done | 1 in progress | 1 block

Replying — use the number from the list, then the word:

You send	What happens
done	Task 1 is closed. You get a thumbs-up reaction as confirmation.
in progress	Task 2 is marked started.
block <reason>	Task 3 is marked blocked with your reason, and the admin is told immediately. Always include the reason.
reopen	Made a mistake? This reopens a task you closed.
one	If you have only one open task, no number is needed.

Even easier — swipe to reply. Swipe (long-press → Reply) on the task's message and just type done. The bot knows which task you mean. See your list any time: send /mytasks. Confused? Send /help.

Creating a task

Send /add with a title. Mention someone to assign it to them; add !high or !low for priority; end with a date word — today, tomorrow, fri, or 25/07:

```
/add Send Q2 invoice @Priya fri !high
```

```
Create task: "Send Q2 invoice" -> Priya,  
due Fri 17 Jul, high priority?  
Reply Y to confirm, N to cancel.
```

Reply y and it's created — with its number appearing in the right digest tomorrow morning. Nothing is created without your confirmation. In a group, the task shows up in that group's daily list.

Good to know: only you (or an admin) can close your tasks — a teammate can't mark your work done. The bot never reads receipts, never replies to normal conversation, and stays completely silent in chats that aren't registered.

II For the administrator

You run TaskWA from the dashboard at <http://localhost:3000> on the machine where it is installed. Log in with the admin password.

Members

Register each person with a name and their WhatsApp number (country code + number, digits only). The number IS their identity: messages from any other number are ignored silently. admin receives blocker alerts and can update anyone's task; member manages only their own. Deactivating a member stops their digests instantly — reassign their open tasks first.

Groups

Add the bot's number to the group, then click Detect my groups on the Groups page — every group the number belongs to appears with a one-click Register button. Only registered groups are listened to. Tasks flagged 'post to group' appear in that group's daily digest instead of the assignee's personal one.

Settings that matter

Setting	Meaning
Timezone & send times	IANA timezone (e.g. Asia/Dubai) and one or more daily digest times, comma-separated (08:00, 17:00).
Acknowledgment mode	reaction (thumbs-up — recommended), reply (a text 'Noted.'), or silent.
Personal number mode	ON when the bot shares your own WhatsApp number. It then never replies to anything that isn't a command; your own digest arrives in 'Message Yourself'.
Dry-run	The safety switch: ON means every message is logged on the Health page instead of being sent. Use it whenever you experiment.
Hourly cap / retention	Upper bound on messages per hour (ban-risk hygiene) and days before completed tasks are archived to CSV and purged (default 30).

The Health page — your first stop when anything seems wrong

Status	What to do
WORKING	All good. Check 'last digest' and 'last backup' times occasionally.
SCAN_QR_CODE	The WhatsApp pairing dropped. Click Start session, scan the QR with the bot number's phone, refresh.
STARTING	Be patient — 30–60 seconds on Apple Silicon.
FAILED / STOPPED	Click Start / restart session. If it fails repeatedly, restart the gateway container.
UNREACHABLE	The gateway container isn't running — usually right after a reboot; wait a minute. Persisting: <code>docker compose up -d</code> .

The message log at the bottom shows every outbound message with its status — including dryrun (not sent), failed (gateway error, shown), and blocked (recipient not registered — the allowlist protecting you).

Routine care

- Backups are automatic — nightly snapshots, 14 kept, in the backups folder. To restore: stop the app, copy a snapshot over `data/tasks.db`, start again.
- Exports — `tasks.csv` and `audit.csv` from the Tasks page, any time.
- Forgotten password — 'Forgot password' sends a 6-digit code to your WhatsApp. If WhatsApp is down: `docker compose exec app python -m app.cli reset-password`.
- Upgrades — see `docs/UPGRADE.md`; in short: `git pull`, `docker compose up -d --build`. Data survives.
- Keep the machine awake — a sleeping laptop sends no digests. Digits missed by under 6 hours send on wake.

The one standing risk, stated plainly: TaskWA uses an unofficial WhatsApp gateway. WhatsApp can ban the paired number without notice. Keep volumes modest, keep the hourly cap on. Your task data is never at risk — only the delivery channel.